

Populism on YouTube. How German Parties Utilize New Social Media Platforms.

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Abstract

Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit, sed do eiusmod tempor incididunt ut labore et dolore magnam aliquam quaerat voluptatem. Ut enim aequale doleamus animo, cum corpore dolemus, fieri tamen permagna accessio potest, si aliquod aeternum et infinitum impendere malum nobis opinemur. Quod idem licet transferre in voluptatem, ut postea variari voluptas distinguere possit, augeri amplificarique non possit. At etiam Athenis, ut e patre audiebam facete et urbane Stoicos irridente, statua est in quo a nobis philosophia defensa et collaudata est, cum id, quod maxime placeat, facere possimus, omnis voluptas assumenda est, omnis dolor repellendus. Temporibus autem quibusdam et.

Keywords: Populism; YouTube; LLM.

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1 Introduction

Populist parties threaten democratic values and contribute to ideological polarization (Roberts, 2022). Yet it has been heavily on the rise in Western countries for decades. Germany had its populist surge with rise of the Alternative for Germany (AfD). While originally founded as a Euroskeptic response to the problems of the 2008 financial crisis, the party was quickly overtaken by right-wing anti-immigrant sentiment. A sudden influx of migrants during the summer of 2015 gave the AfD's numbers and additional boost. Despite mostly lacking a substantial agenda other than harsh criticism of the established and governing parties, they gained traction across all voter demographics. Some attribute part of this success to social media, which is used far more by populist actors than non-populist ones (CITE?). Although there exist research on populism on other social media platforms, such as TikTok (González-Aguilar et al., 2023), Twitter (Ernst et al., 2017), Instagram (Olof Larsson, 2023), or Facebook (Schürmann & Gründl, 2022), research on YouTube is still lacking (Munger et al., 2025). While in previous years TV was "considered to be the most important advertising medium and televised political advertising a leading way of communication between candidates voters" (Vesnic-Alujevic & Van Bauwel, 2014, 199) and it probably still is, its place at the top is being fiercely contested by emerging players on the web. Social media, especially YouTube as one of the largest platforms, is an important but understudied place where populism is being spread.

With the rise of YouTube as one of the most important social media networks on the Internet, it still lacks a thorough investigation (Rauchfleisch & Kaiser, 2020). This article aims to take a closer look at the usage patterns YouTube by German political parties. A glance at the number of likes and followers for the parties' channels shows that the populist Alternative for Germany (AfD) has a massively larger followership on this platform than any other party.

Even without the direct interaction between content creators and viewers, this platform provides an easy way for almost everyone to create and share content. Of course, the German parties are also taking the opportunity to be represented on the platform, albeit with varying degrees of success. While the audience is behind some of the more influential accounts on this platform, an examination of the content shared on YouTube allows us to examine the parties' self-representation in more detail.² This research aims to take a closer look at the use and spread of populism on YouTube by German political parties.

Research Question: How do German political parties utilize YouTube and to what extent does populism influence the popularity of their content?

2 Theory

2.1 YouTube as a Research Platform

YouTube is very popular in Germany (Allgaier, 2020). A fairly recent representative study among young Germans reports that 60% used the site daily or at least several times a week (Feierabend et al., 2018). The study also shows that YouTube is the second most important site for respondents to obtain news and information, trailing only Google.

While the YouTube is still dramatically understudied compared to other social media platforms (Munger et al., 2025), increasing effort is undertaken to systematically analyze content on YouTube in general and the *political* YouTube in particular (Bärtl, 2018; Munger et al., 2025).

YouTube is the only major social media network more popular among right-leaning users (Munger & Phillips, 2022). Additionally, and in contrast to other parties, populists prefer social media over talk shows (Ernst et al., 2019). As Engesser et al. (2017a, 1123) indicate,

²There are some successful channels of German politicians like Sarah Wagenknecht (with 673,000 followers) or Alice Weidel (with 292,000 followers) with personal channels (checked on February 26, 2025). Nevertheless, in this study we focus on the party channels.

the logic of social media platforms gives them more freedom to use strong language when attacking elites or ostracizing others.

YouTube can be seen as a social media platform. Since everybody can publish content on this platform with very few hurdles, and viewers can self-select what content they are willing to watch, it is natural to view YouTube as a social network between people that is centered around sharing video content—in a way like Instagram is a social network centered around images. Studies that take such an approach might see YouTube from a supply-and-demand perspective, analyzing the side of the content creators and the viewers (Munger & Phillips, 2022). While investigating YouTube through such a lens is a worthwhile endeavor, it might not be suitable to investigate politicians' content. Many scholars have proposed theories on why politicians, particularly populists, choose social media platforms over traditional hierarchical media. Nevertheless, populist leaders mostly utilize social media as a supplementary one-way broadcasting system, instead of interacting with citizens as Jungherr (2016) shows in a systematic literature review on twitter use in election campaigns. They might argue the social media facilitates personal and interactive conversations compared to the more traditional broadcasts through legacy media. Waisbord & Amado (2017), for instance, have shown remarkably low interaction between Latin American politicians, populist and non-populist, on Twitter.

This leads to believe, that videos on YouTube are best viewed from content delivery perspective first.

2.2 Populism

There are several key approaches in the literature on populism, the ideational, the strategic, and the discursive-performative approach (Moffitt, 2020), or as a style of communication (Jagers & Walgrave, 2007). Although scholars have had a lively discussion about what the “correct” definition is (Aslanidis, 2016), we will follow Engesser et al. (2017b) and see these approaches not as mutually exclusive, but argue that all definitions shed light on

different aspects of populism (Engesser et al., 2017a, p. 1280). Another scholar puts this aspect of the scholarly discussion as:

There is actually a fair degree of agreement among academics: most specialists are of the view that populism revolves around a central division between “the people” and “the elite”. In other words, there is considerable consensus about the core features of populism. (Moffitt, 2020)

The most popular definition of populism in the empirical literature is given by Cas Mudde (2004). This approach frames populism primarily as a conflict between the corrupt elite and the virtuous people and therefore focuses on two key notions: anti-elitism and people-centrism. Populism in this context emphasizes the homogeneous nature of the people, often depicted as a cultural or economic entity, and defines the elite variably depending on context (Mudde & Rovira Kaltwasser, 2018). It is seen as a “thin-centered ideology” with a narrow scope compared to broader ideologies like nativism or socialism, which it can accompany (Hawkins et al., 2019; Mudde, 2004). Populism, seen as a thin ideology, describes a worldview that is characterized above all by the antagonistic relationship between the virtuous people and the corrupt elite, which is linked to a thick ideology (Mudde, 2004). Understanding populist rhetoric and claims that support this antagonism is thereby key to explaining their electoral success (de Vreese et al., 2018).

Another notable perspective on populism is the discursive-performative approach. Rooted in the work of Ernesto Laclau, it is by far the most common approach by political theorists (Moffitt, 2020). Although this approach is less prevalent in the empirical literature, as it is considered “extremely abstract” and faces “serious problems when it comes to analysing populism in more concrete terms” (Mudde & Rovira Kaltwasser, 2012, p. 6), it offers several valuable features that are applied in this work. While Moffitt (2020, Table 2.1) makes a clear distinction in that the ideational approach views populism as a purely binary attribute of political actors, Mudde recognizes a gradual “more or less populism” and merely qualifies that it makes little sense to speak of “weak populists” in the case of non-populist actors who use some populist phrases (Mudde, 2017).

This allows us to detect ‘more or less’ populism in specific texts. Secondly, we see populism less as an attribute of political actors but rather see it as a practice that political actors consciously choose to employ to convey an ideology to the audience. Assuming that parties behave similarly on YouTube as they do elsewhere in the political landscape, we can state:

H1: *Populist parties convey more populist content on YouTube than non-populist parties.*

2.3 Populist attitudes

Populism research is mostly divided into two different parts. There is one strain that detects populism in political actors or parts of discourse like speeches. And there is another strain that is concerned with measuring populist attitudes among populations (Akkerman et al., 2014; Hawkins et al., 2020).

A notable aspect of analyzing populist communication on Social Media is that we are able to analyze direct feedback in terms of views, likes and comments on very specific bits of populist communication. According to Kefford et al. (2022) they are the first to try to bridge this gap and try link populist communication and populist attitudes in terms of voting behavior. From a theoretical perspective, they achieve this by combining the ideational approach and the discursive-performative approach. We follow their tradition loosely and believe we can at least get a rough grasp of how people react to populist communication, how their attitudes towards populist communication is, or in other words: what they do or do not ‘like’.

This highlights a major advantage of analyzing populist communication on social media platforms, namely the ability to gauge public responses to populist messaging. This process not only involves detecting populist content published by political actors but also measuring audience reactions through various platform-specific metrics such as likes, dislikes, views, or shares. While the audiences on these platforms are often partisan and

vary across different channels, comparing how distinct publics (i.e. viewers, followers, or subscribers) engage with content—whether it leans towards populism or not—offers valuable insights into broader public sentiment and interaction patterns.

Given this premise, we expect populist parties as well as populist content to be popular among people with populist attitudes. We also hypothesize the opposite to be true: populist parties as well as populist content will not be especially popular among people with less populist attitudes. We can there formulate the following hypotheses:

H2a: *On channels of populist parties, we expect a positive relationship between a videos' amount of contained populism and it's user engagement.*

H2b: *On non-populist channels, we expect no positive relationship between a videos' amount of populism and user engagement.*

3 Data & Methods

Our research methodology begins by retrieving the audio material from all the videos under investigation. A speech-to-text tool is then employed to extract the transcripts from these videos, effectively converting the auditory data into analyzable text. Finally, an LLM model is applied to the transcripts to detect populism, providing a systematic and automated approach to identifying populist language in the content. All steps are described in the following in more detail.

3.1 YouTube Data

Using their official channels, we collected a dataset comprising YouTube videos from all six political parties within the German Bundestag. The FDP (Free Democratic Party) with @FDP, the Greens with @DieGruenen, the SPD (Social Democratic Party) with @spdde and the Left with @DIELINKE have easily identifiable main official party channels. The CDU (Christian Democratic Union) and CSU (Christian Social Union) are two separate political parties in Germany that operate as sister parties. The CDU is active in all German

states except Bavaria, where the CSU operates exclusively. For this reason, both parties also maintain separate YouTube channels with @cdutv and @csumedia, although they are regarded as a single party within the Bundestag. Conversely, the AfD’s (Alternative for Germany) official channel (@AfDTV) is distinct from the parliamentary group’s channel (@AfDFraktionimBundestag). Both channels, exhibiting comparable follower counts, were incorporated into our analysis. Consequently, our dataset encompasses a total of eight channels. The dataset is restricted to the period from December 6, 2017 (the final channel’s inaugural video publication) to February 24, 2025, the day of the Bundestagswahl 2025.

3.2 Video transcripts

The analysis of video material is very challenging, we therefore follow Schwemmer & Ziewiecki (2018) and focus our analysis on the audio material. The audio data of all videos and their accompanying metadata were downloaded using *yt-dlp*. In contrast to the abovementioned article, who use the pre-generated transcripts provided by YouTube, we use a state-of-the-art speech-to-text model to transcribe the audio material ourselves. This procedure ensures an enhanced quality of the transcripts, including correct punctuation and music recognition.

The content of the videos was transcribed using OpenAI’s advanced speech-to-text model, Whisper-large-v3-turbo (Radford et al., 2022). This model provides significantly faster transcription compared to Whisper-large-v3 while maintaining comparable accuracy. However, Whisper models tend to produce erroneous transcriptions, known as hallucinations, particularly when the audio includes extended periods without speech, a common occurrence in YouTube videos. To address this issue, we employed the Silero voice activity detector (Silero, 2024), isolating segments containing actual speech and passing only these segments to the Whisper transcription model. Although this approach effectively reduced the number of hallucinations, 80 videos had to be excluded from the analysis due to faulty transcripts. Faulty transcripts were identified by generating all n-grams for

values of n between 2 and 10, and determining whether any n -gram appeared more than nine consecutive times within a transcript.

Subsequently, the transcriptions were tokenized and segmented into sentences using the current version of the SoMaJo tokenizer and sentence-splitter (Proisl & Uhrig, 2016). After removing sentences with less than 3 tokens and videos with less than 5 sentences (mostly music-only videos with written text on screen), our clean dataset comprises 12,178 videos, totaling 1,659.2 hours of playtime and containing 908,222 sentences.

3.3 Detecting Populism

To detect populism in transcripts of YouTube videos from the official channels of the German parties in the Bundestag, we apply PopBERT, a BERT-based transformer model, fine-tuned to specifically detect anti-elitism and people-centrism in German political speech (Erhard et al., 2024).

Although PopBERT was trained on transcripts of parliamentary speeches, we consider its application to videos from official party channels feasible. There is a high degree of similarity in tone, vocabulary, and rhetorical style between these two contexts. Additionally, there is substantial overlap in the speakers themselves, and the videos originate predominantly from the same time period as the training data. Therefore, we expect the model to reliably generalize to this closely related domain.

4 Results

The analysis begins with an examination of the descriptive statistics across all channels. Subsequently, the focus shifts to exploring the relationship between populism and the popularity of videos.

4.1 German Parties on YouTube

Summary statistics per channel are presented in Table 1. A notable observation is that each of the two AfD channels—@AfDFraktionimBundestag (521,000 followers), hereafter referred to as AfD BT, and @AfDTV (334,000 followers)—individually has more followers than all other analyzed channels combined (252,410 followers). While the CDU, FDP, Greens, and SPD channels have comparable follower counts around 30,000 each, the CSU, the smaller “sister party” of the CDU limited to Bavaria, has only 6,610 followers. In contrast, the Left party, another populist party represented in the Bundestag alongside the AfD, has a substantially higher follower count of 117,000, highlighting the greater popularity of populist parties compared to their non-populist counterparts.

	AfD BT	AfD TV	CDU	CSU	FDP	Greens	Left	SPD
chFollowers	521000	334000	30000	6610	28900	35400	117000	34500
nVideos	6181	1829	827	172	725	643	748	1053
nLikesNA	0	108	1	4	724	7	3	2
meanViews	53458.1	53608.69	20985.7	26680.87	22122.65	16637.37	29150.05	10700.02
medianViews	16477	19754	1291	923	1191	1316	3505.5	2435
meanLikes	4362.1	4374.74	200.7	45.23	105	196.57	1876.49	192.61
medianLikes	2053	2553	28	24	105	32	164	85
meanVideoLen	411.38	558.9	569.28	436.01	566.59	603.97	585.01	594.14
nSentences	374926	172537	73946	13608	58962	55008	65262	93973

Table 1: Summary statistics of the dataset. All data is current as of February 25, 2025, the day after the federal election. **chFollowers** corresponds to the number of followers that are shown given in the channel description; this number is most probably rounded to some degree by YouTube. **meanVideoLen** is shown in seconds. **nLikesNA** corresponds to the number of returned missings for the like_count from the API, indicating that the like functionality is disabled for a particular video. **nSentences** corresponds to the number of sentences extracted from all valid videos per channel.

The volume of videos produced follows a similar pattern, with both AfD channels demonstrating significantly higher productivity and engagement measured as median views and likes, followed by the Left. However, the average like count reported for the FDP may be misleading, as the like functionality has been disabled for all but one video on their channel. Comparing median and mean values for both likes and views reveals a substantial analytical challenge inherent to YouTube data. Specifically, the means are substantially

higher than the medians for all metrics, indicating a highly skewed distribution driven upward by a few exceptionally successful videos. Figure 1 illustrates the distributions of views and likes to examine these disparities more closely. Due to considerable variation in the raw counts, views and likes are displayed on a logarithmic scale.

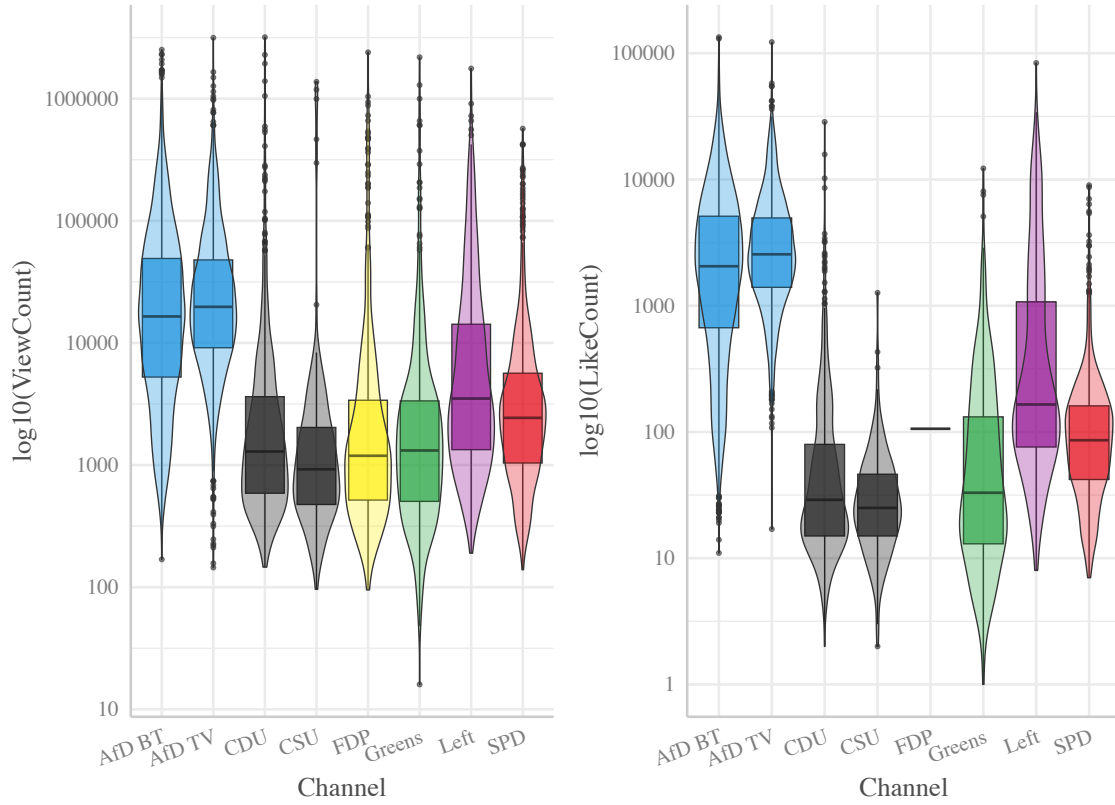


Figure 1: Distribution of likes and views per channel. All values are logged. The rectangle describes the .25, .5 and .75 quantiles. Outliers are represented by dots. Violin plots were superimposed on the boxplot to better visualize the distribution.

In addition to the above-mentioned differences in median views and likes, we can see in this figure that all parties have some very successful videos in terms of views. It is evident that all parties produce some successful videos, but the AfD stands out clearly here as well.

4.2 Populism by German Parties on YouTube

Figure 2 shows the relative proportion of sentences classified by PopBERT as anti-elitist and people-centrist by video. It becomes immediately apparent that both channels of the AfD exhibit a much higher proportion of anti-elitist statements than the channels of

any other party. The second highest amount of anti-elitist statements, though exhibiting substantially lower numbers, is expressed by the Left; the other populist party in the Bundestag. People-Centrism, on the other hand, draws a different picture. The Greens, the Left and the SPD all show similar high amounts of this populist dimension, though, in contrast to the anti-elitism dimension, no party surpasses a relative proportion of 5%.

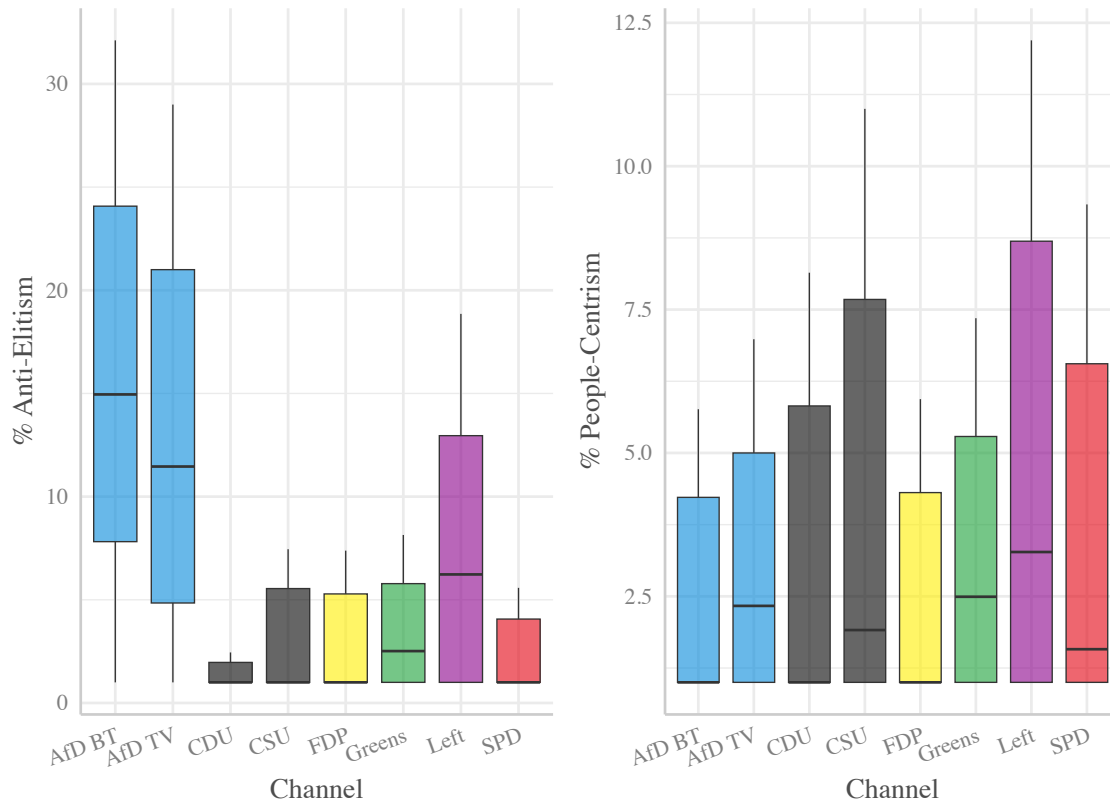


Figure 2: Each case in this figure is a video; the values represent the relative proportion of sentences that are flagged with the respective populist dimension.

4.3 Populism and Popularity

A key finding here is that only the populist parties (both AfD channels and the Left) show a clear correlation between the number of likes of a video and populist dimensions. This suggests that people who watch videos from populist parties do so deliberately and in search of anti-elitist content. This effect is not seen for people-centrism. As illustrated in Table 1, the FDP has received an almost negligible number of likes on their videos. A review of their YouTube content reveals that the FDP has disabled the like feature on

nearly all of their videos. Consequently, we will exclude the FDP from the subsequent analysis relating to the number of likes.

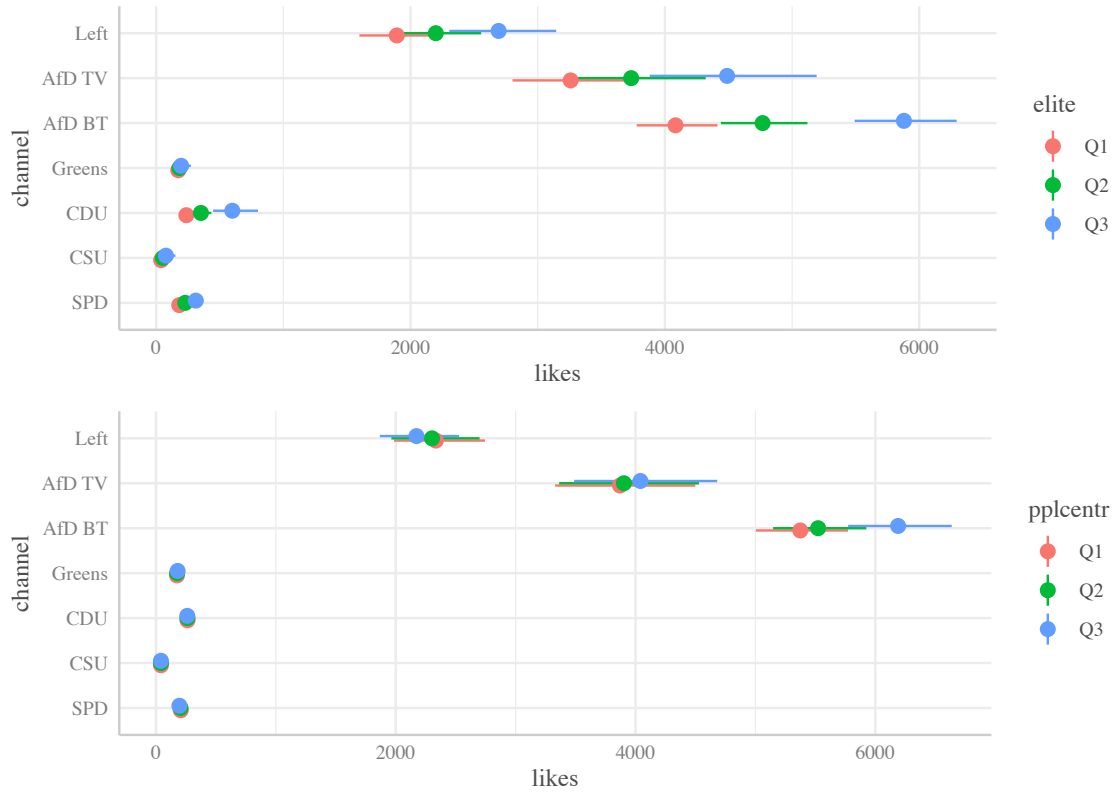


Figure 3: Negative Binomial Regression on Number of Likes per Video. Anti-elitism is z-transformed by the channel mean. Channel and Anti-Elitism are modeled using an interaction effect. We control for the year of release and video length.

5 Discussion

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Appendix

Appendix A: Top 10 most viewed video per channel

Channel	N Likes	N Views	Title
SPD	2977	568032	Was ist eigentlich alles drin, wenn man die SPD wählt?
SPD	8682	425526	Lothar Binding erklärt Friedrich Merz #spdbpt23
SPD	555	419221	Bedrohungen in Schach halten - SPD wählen! Wahlspot Europawahl 2024
SPD	3628	418169	Die CDU hat keine Ahnung von Dönern!
SPD	5397	271450	Kanzler Scholz entlässt Lindner, Vertrauensfrage im Januar Ganze Rede
SPD	7022	262199	Reaktion auf Rezo Statement Lars Klingbeil, Tiemo Wölken, Kevin Kühnert
SPD	9002	260311	CDU greift Bürgergeld an: Anke Rehlinger grillt CDU-Amthor!
SPD	181	245957	Was am 9. Juni für dich mit der SPD drin ist
SPD	6370	233342	Kevin Kühnert hält letzte Rede im Bundestag - emotionaler Abschied
SPD	1303	228200	Am 23.2. SPD und Olaf Scholz wählen
Left	83699	1765469	Gregor Gysi: So kommen Reiche in den Himmel!
Left	25015	909893	Caren Lay nimmt die AfD-Männer auseinander, die angeblich Frauenrechte verteidigen
Left	17475	722882	Stefan Liebich zerpfückt die Fakenews der AfD zum Migrationspakt
Left	16518	658816	Gregor Gysi ZERLEGT Trump Live Im TV!
Left	18549	560139	Gregor Gysi ZERLEGT Die Schuldenbremse Bei Hart Aber Fair!
Left	28155	502067	Gregor Gysi: Die Mitte Schützen, Nicht Die Milliardäre! #shorts
Left	29018	422206	Gregor Gysi: Warum die arbeitende Mitte drauf zahlt!
Left	24423	395993	Gregor Gysi Rechnet KNALLHART Mit Der AfD Ab!
Left	19200	395800	Die WICHTIGSTE Rede Über Den Pakt Von Merz Und AfD! Heidi Reichinnek Spricht KLARTEXT!
Left	24186	356192	Heidi Reichinnek Präsentiert: Die Zerstörung Des Friedrich Merz
Greens	8062	2182760	Zeichen BÜNDNIS 90/DIE GRÜNEN
Greens	1969	1292102	Ein Bündnis. Ein Wort. Wahlwerbespot zur Bundestagswahl 2025 BÜNDNIS 90/DIE GRÜNEN
Greens	12237	999314	Ein schöner Land – Grüner Spot zur Bundestagswahl 2021
Greens	2877	657714	Wir brauchen einen Bündniskanzler
Greens	7559	607241	Wir schützen Frauen und Kinder besser vor Gewalt!
Greens	5091	605715	Mit Verantwortung durch die Energiekrise
Greens	1497	374228	Machen, was zählt! – Wahlwerbespot zur Europawahl von BÜNDNIS 90/DIE GRÜNEN
Greens	911	290676	Wir stärken Frauen am Arbeitsplatz!
Greens	2171	207037	Annalena Baerbock über die Stärke Europas und warum Abschottung Deutschland schwächt
Greens	2274	205560	Was sollen wir sagen: Können wir gut verstehen. 🤝
CSU	429	1374885	Ja zu Bayern!

Channel	N Likes	N Views	Title
CSU	322	1185672	Landtagswahl am 8. Oktober 2023 - Damit Bayern stark und stabil bleibt
CSU	1265	995434	Bundestagswahl am 23. Februar 2025 - Bayern stark in Deutschland!
CSU		464817	Wahlspot zur Bundestagswahl 2021 - Damit Bayern in Deutschland stark bleibt!
CSU	119	297534	Europawahl 2024: Für ein starkes Bayern in Europa!
CSU	98	20546	Manfred Weber - Unser Mann für Europa
CSU	143	8346	Ja zu Bayern!
CSU	67	8255	CSU Europawahl
CSU	100	7111	Best-of Aschermittwoch 2021 #dahoAM
CSU	99	6535	EPISODE 2 - "Neue Töne" -der Polit-Podcast der CSU mit Markus Söder
CDU	1036	3186992	Politikwechsel mit Friedrich Merz! Beide Stimmen CDU.
CDU	711	2286979	Wieder nach vorne! Am 23. Februar mit beiden Stimmen CDU.
CDU	3416	1391632	Deutschland gemeinsam machen.
CDU	28585	1051621	Politikwechsel mit Friedrich Merz! Beide Stimmen CDU.
CDU	401	592431	Wahlaufruf von Kanzlerkandidat Armin Laschet: Es ist nicht egal, wer unser Land regiert!
CDU	123	558033	60 Sekunden für unser Europa.
CDU	15792	531857	Schön, dass Frau Faeser es heute zur #Generaldebatte in den Bundestag geschafft hat! #merz #shorts
CDU	134	409051	Weil alles mit allem zusammenhängt.
CDU	2169	283605	Grußwort Donald Tusk
CDU	685	274689	Alles, was wir tun, tun wir aus Verantwortung für unser Land. Und: #wegenmorgen.
AfD TV	122625	3153031	Der Weidel-Hammer: Bei dieser Rede tobte der Bundestag! - AfD - Alice Weidel
AfD TV	57769	1651184	„Sie, Herr Habeck, wollen den Untergang Deutschlands! Wir nicht.“
AfD TV	23181	1490379	Claudia Roth tickt aus, weil die AfD nicht gendert!
AfD TV	41685	1269180	Bürgergeld sorgt dafür, dass sich Arbeit nicht lohnt
AfD TV	22414	1144006	Das AfD-Programm zur Europawahl in 99 Sekunden!
AfD TV	38219	1047360	Was die Grünen und die DDR gemeinsam haben!
AfD TV	28057	995828	AfD benennt Täter, Bundestag rastet komplett aus!
AfD TV	24075	972758	AfD-Fraktion holt Baerbock zurück auf den Boden
AfD TV	55002	812044	Gänsehaut pur bei dieser Rede! - AfD - Livemitschnitt Alice Weidel Magdeburg
AfD TV	54554	770314	+++ Keine Extrawurst für Ukrainer! +++
AfD BT	79836	2515085	Baerbock stinksauer: Markus Frohnmaier entlarvt Doppelmoral der Außenministerin! - AfD-Fraktion
AfD BT	134032	2309305	Alice Weidel rechnet mit den Deutschland-Hassern von der Regierung ab! - AfD-Fraktion im Bundestag
AfD BT	130224	2303050	Alice Weidel auf 180! So hat sie noch nie mit der Ampel abgerechnet! - AfD-Fraktion im Bundestag
AfD BT	66345	2082627	Entgleisung von Göring-Eckardt bei Applaus für AfD-Rede! Martinichert - AfD-Fraktion im Bundestag

Channel	N Likes	N Views	Title
AfD BT	35188	1928110	AfD verursacht Sitzungssabbruch! - AfD-Fraktion im Bundestag
AfD BT	76964	1722897	Markus Frohnmaier ermahnt Baerbock in Debatte über Krieg und Frieden! - AfD-Fraktion im Bundestag
AfD BT	66438	1713000	Beatrix von Storch rechnet mit den Klima-Spinnern ab! - AfD-Fraktion im Bundestag
AfD BT	66020	1695453	Stefan Keuter rechnet mit Baerbock ab! - AfD-Fraktion im Bundestag
AfD BT	62451	1647853	Zwischenfrage geht nach hinten los: Grüne bekommen Standpauke ihres Lebens! - Martin Hess - AfD
AfD BT	48078	1616817	AfD-Fraktion grillt Nancy Faeser! - Regierungsbefragung

Table A1: Most successful videos. Shown are the top 10 videos ordered by video_likes. The FDP is excluded due to their videos having basically no likes.

Appendix B: Top 10 most liked videos per channel

Channel	N Likes	N Views	Title
SPD	9002	260311	CDU greift Bürgergeld an: Anke Rehlinger grillt CDU-Amthor!
SPD	8682	425526	Lothar Binding erklärt Friedrich Merz #spdbpt23
SPD	7022	262199	Reaktion auf Rezo Statement Lars Klingbeil, Tiemo Wölken, Kevin Kühnert
SPD	6370	233342	Kevin Kühnert hält letzte Rede im Bundestag - emotionaler Abschied
SPD	5590	184766	Boris Pistorius antwortet auf Vorwürfe von US-Vizepräsident Vance.
SPD	5397	271450	Kanzler Scholz entlässt Lindner, Vertrauensfrage im Januar Ganze Rede
SPD	3628	418169	Die CDU hat keine Ahnung von Dönern!
SPD	3228	125674	Rede von Kevin Kühnert
SPD	3004	149897	Was Franz Müntefering über Friedrich Merz sagen möchte.
SPD	2977	568032	Was ist eigentlich alles drin, wenn man die SPD wählt?
Left	83699	1765469	Gregor Gysi: So kommen Reiche in den Himmel!
Left	34261	333276	Heidi Reichinnek RAPPT Das Wahlprogramm in 40 SEKUNDEN Runter! #shorts #Politik
Left	29614	192130	Gregor Gysi und Heidi Reichinnek: In der falschen Partei? Nope ❌ #shorts
Left	29018	422206	Gregor Gysi: Warum die arbeitende Mitte drauf zahlt!
Left	28155	502067	Gregor Gysi: Die Mitte Schützen, Nicht Die Milliardäre! #shorts
Left	27053	265542	Janine Wissler Führt CDU CSU Wegen ANTI CANNABIS Antrag Vor!
Left	25015	909893	Caren Lay nimmt die AfD-Männer auseinander, die angeblich Frauenrechte verteidigen
Left	24423	395993	Gregor Gysi Rechnet KNALLHART Mit Der AfD Ab!
Left	24186	356192	Heidi Reichinnek Präsentiert: Die Zerstörung Des Friedrich Merz
Left	19200	395800	Die WICHTIGSTE Rede Über Den Pakt Von Merz Und AfD! Heidi Reichinnek Spricht KLARTEXT!
Greens	12237	999314	Ein schöner Land – Grüner Spot zur Bundestagswahl 2021

Channel	N Likes	N Views	Title
Greens	8062	2182760	Zeichen BÜNDNIS 90/DIE GRÜNEN
Greens	7559	607241	Wir schützen Frauen und Kinder besser vor Gewalt!
Greens	5091	605715	Mit Verantwortung durch die Energiekrise
Greens	2877	657714	Wir brauchen einen Bündniskanzler
Greens	2274	205560	Was sollen wir sagen: Können wir gut verstehen. 🤔
Greens	2171	207037	Annalena Baerbock über die Stärke Europas und warum Abschottung Deutschland schwächt
Greens	2160	149553	Marion und Ingrid aus Köln BÜNDNIS 90/DIE GRÜNEN
Greens	2009	24781	Annalena Baerbock trifft Ricardo Lange am Küchentisch
Greens	1993	130734	Felix Banaszak: "Deutschland muss sich neu erfinden!"
CSU	1265	995434	Bundestagswahl am 23. Februar 2025 - Bayern stark in Deutschland!
CSU	429	1374885	Ja zu Bayern!
CSU	322	1185672	Landtagswahl am 8. Oktober 2023 - Damit Bayern stark und stabil bleibt
CSU	217	4567	Fail des Tages "Danke, Antifa!"
CSU	172	3869	Fail des Tages I Öffentliches Gelöbnis der Bundeswehr
CSU	143	8346	Ja zu Bayern!
CSU	123	4241	Best Of Bodo Bodenlos
CSU	119	297534	Europawahl 2024: Für ein starkes Bayern in Europa!
CSU	104	3914	Gründung der CSU
CSU	100	7111	Best-of Aschermittwoch 2021 #dahoAM
CDU	28585	1051621	Politikwechsel mit Friedrich Merz! Beide Stimmen CDU.
CDU	15792	531857	Schön, dass Frau Faeser es heute zur #Generaldebatte in den Bundestag geschafft hat! #merz #shorts
CDU	10216	174067	Es muss #SOFORT gehandelt werden! Unsere #Wirtschaft schmiert ab! #cdu #linnemann #shorts
CDU	3715	104456	 Der #Deutschlandpakt des Kanzlers ist ein #Hilferuf! #cdu #linnemann #shorts
CDU	3416	1391632	Deutschland gemeinsam machen.
CDU	3178	225938	Einfach mal machen – Folge #7 mit Anna Schneider und Richard David Precht
CDU	2610	51379	Wir wollen ein vernünftiges Staatsbürgerschaftsrecht! #cdu
CDU	2529	52952	Wir können nicht auf Kosten der nächsten Generation leben! #linnemann #wirtschaft #cdu #shorts
CDU	2429	996	#Deutschlandreise: Das Reisetagebuch. 26. August 2021: Korschenbroich
CDU	2244	1552	#Deutschlandreise: Das Reisetagebuch. 3. September 2021: Apolda, Eisenach und Erfurt
AfD TV	122625	3153031	Der Weidel-Hammer: Bei dieser Rede tobte der Bundestag! - AfD - Alice Weidel
AfD TV	57769	1651184	„Sie, Herr Habeck, wollen den Untergang Deutschlands! Wir nicht.“
AfD TV	55002	812044	Gänsehaut pur bei dieser Rede! - AfD - Livemitschnitt Alice Weidel Magdeburg
AfD TV	54554	770314	+++ Keine Extrawurst für Ukrainer! +++
AfD TV	42169	492527	„Diese Maßnahmen sind ein himmelschreiendes Verbrechen!“

Channel	N Likes	N Views	Title
AfD TV	41685	1269180	Bürgergeld sorgt dafür, dass sich Arbeit nicht lohnt
AfD TV	38219	1047360	Was die Grünen und die DDR gemeinsam haben!
AfD TV	37902	537199	„Zwei Jahre Corona-Politik waren gebaut auf falschen Zahlen!“
AfD TV	36106	553312	Der Weidel-Hammer im Bundestag: "Was haben Sie da auf unser Volk losgelassen?"
AfD TV	31610	403822	Das hat gegessen! Martin Hess nimmt hier kein Blatt vor den Mund!
AfD BT	134032	2309305	Alice Weidel rechnet mit den Deutschland-Hassern von der Regierung ab! - AfD-Fraktion im Bundestag
AfD BT	130224	2303050	Alice Weidel auf 180! So hat sie noch nie mit der Ampel abgerechnet! - AfD-Fraktion im Bundestag
AfD BT	95685	1486748	Alice Weidel auf 180!: So hat wurde noch nie mit den Altparteien abgerechnet! - AfD-Fraktion
AfD BT	86312	1344943	Baerbock ist eine einzige große Peinlichkeit! #afd #baerbock #scholz #habeck
AfD BT	82919	1047507	Grüne spielen bald keine Rolle mehr! #chrupalla #afd #hartaberfair
AfD BT	82029	1148449	Alice Weidel knöpft sich die Grünen vor! 😂 - AfD-Fraktion im Bundestag
AfD BT	79836	2515085	Baerbock stinksauer: Markus Frohnmaier entlarvt Doppelmoral der Außenministerin! - AfD-Fraktion
AfD BT	76964	1722897	Markus Frohnmaier ermahnt Baerbock in Debatte über Krieg und Frieden! - AfD-Fraktion im Bundestag
AfD BT	74461	1368864	Migrationsmurks der Ampel bringt Norbert Kleinwächter auf 180! 🌟 - AfD-Fraktion im Bundestag
AfD BT	72922	864699	Merz stinksauer: Alice Weidel rechnet knallhart mit der CDU ab! - AfD-Fraktion im Bundestag

Table B1: Most successful videos. Shown are the top 10 videos ordered by video_likes. The FDP is excluded due to their videos having basically no likes.

Appendix C: Top 10 most anti-elitist videos per channel

Channel	Sents	Anti-Elite	Title
SPD	1407	47	#UnsereSPD – Die Tour. Kamen, 28. September 2019
SPD	1334	45	#UnsereSPD – Die Tour. Duisburg, 6. Oktober 2019
SPD	441	45	Politischer Aschermittwoch: Kampfansage von Lars an die Demokratiefinde
SPD	1300	41	#UnsereSPD – Die Tour. Neumünster, 21. September 2019
SPD	1366	40	#UnsereSPD – Die Tour. Troisdorf, 29. September 2019
SPD	554	30	Rede von Martin Schulz, 7.12.2017
SPD	1404	29	#UnsereSPD – Die Tour. Bernburg a.d. Saale, 7. September
SPD	1343	26	#UnsereSPD – Die Tour. Saarbrücken, 4. September
SPD	1414	25	#UnsereSPD – Die Tour. Bremen, 8. September
SPD	293	25	Lars Klingbeils Rede beim politischen Gillamoos 2023

Channel	Sents	Anti-Elite	Title
Left	633	82	Leipzig: Heißer Herbst gegen die soziale Kälte!
Left	827	80	Europaparteitag: Generaldebatte
Left	813	68	Leipziger Parteitag: Generaldebatte
Left	853	51	Gremiensitzung zum Jahresauftakt 2019
Left	1051	41	Systemchange durch Green New Deal? Riexinger trifft Neubauer
Left	288	40	Wir schlagen ein neues Kapitel auf. Rede von Janine Wissler
Left	670	40	Politischer Aschermittwoch: Klaus Ernst
Left	305	35	Das Land ist geeint in Unzufriedenheit mit der Ampel. Rede von Dietmar Bartsch
Left	246	35	Statt Reichtum für Wenige: Eine Wirtschaft die für alle funktioniert! Mit Ines Schwerdtner
Left	162	34	Amira Mohamed Ali: Wir legen uns jeden Tag mit den Reichen und Mächtigen an
Greens	2581	72	Grüner Bundesparteitag in Bielefeld 2019 Freitag 15. November
Greens	173	28	Simone Peter auf der Bundesdelegiertenkonferenz 2018
Greens	156	20	Ab wann ist Wahlkampf demokratieschädigend? Webinar mit Annika Brockschmidt
Greens	871	20	Wahlkampftour mit Robert Habeck und Annalena Baerbock in Berlin
Greens	697	19	Jugend in der Krise - Forum zu Perspektiven der Jugend
Greens	514	19	Trump vs. Biden – Webinar mit Jamila Schäfer
Greens	644	19	Ein Blick über den Tellerrand die Coronakrise in der Welt
Greens	158	17	Robert Habeck Rede auf dem #Wahlparteitag
Greens	497	17	Welche Vision einer Europäischen Außenpolitik brauchen wir?
Greens	517	16	Robert Habecks Rede zu seiner Kandidatur für den Bundestagswahlkampf 2025 #BDK50
FDP	456	40	Christian Lindner beim Dreikönigstreffen in Stuttgart 2025 #3K25
FDP	279	34	Beer zur Europa
FDP	541	33	Für den harten und riskanten Weg entschieden
FDP	477	33	Bundespressekonferenz mit Lindner und Buschmann
FDP	371	28	Es geht um unser Land Christian Lindner #bpt25
FDP	615	27	Digitales Dreikönigstreffen - Komplettes Video der Veranstaltung #3K21
FDP	256	26	Marie-Agnes Strack-Zimmermann auf dem Bundesparteitag der Freien Demokraten #bpt24 #Wachstum
FDP	515	26	Rede von Christian Lindner beim Dreikönigstreffen der Freien Demokraten 2018
FDP	555	26	Rede Lindner #3K19
FDP	640	26	Rede Christian Lindner
CSU	764	38	Politischer Aschermittwoch 2020: Rede von CSU-Chef Markus Söder
CSU	501	22	EPISODE 3 "Neue Töne" - der Polit-Podcast der CSU mit Jan Fleischhauer
CSU	320	19	Frauengedeck - Ein bayerischer Podcast #2 Dorothee Bär - Silvaner
CSU	540	17	Rede von Markus Söder am #csupt19
CSU	301	11	Q&A mit Markus Söder

Channel	Sents	Anti-Elite	Title
CSU	645	10	EPISODE 2 - "Neue Töne" -der Polit-Podcast der CSU mit Markus Söder
CSU	58	10	Der CSU-Parteitag 2021 - Stabilität statt Linksrutsch
CSU	426	8	Frauengedeck - Ein bayerischer Podcast #3 Christina Stumpp - Winzersekt
CSU	549	8	EPISODE 4 "Neue Töne" - der Polit-Podcast der CSU mit Kristina Frank
CSU	310	7	Pressekonzferenz nach der gemeinsamen Klausurtagung von CSU und CDU in Dresden
CDU	4724	92	CDU Parteitag in Leipzig am 22.11.2019 #cdupt19
CDU	2699	57	CDU Parteitag in Leipzig am 23.11.2019 #cdupt19
CDU	422	41	Geschlossen und entschlossen: Markus Söder auf dem CDU-Parteitag
CDU	483	35	Markus Söder: Gemeinsam sind wir stark 37. Parteitag
CDU	490	29	Einfach mal machen – Spezial mit Markus Söder und Friedrich Merz
CDU	636	28	Einfach mal machen – Folge #3 mit Caroline Bosbach und Philipp Amthor
CDU	699	22	Einfach mal machen – Folge #7 mit Anna Schneider und Richard David Precht
CDU	1567	22	#CDUVorsitz: Regionalkonferenz Seebach
CDU	1651	21	CDU.TV: Video zur 1. Regionalkonferenz Lübeck #CDUVorsitz
CDU	627	21	Einfach mal machen – Folge #13 mit Michel Friedman und Bernd Siggelkow
AfD TV	1426	223	AfD-Wahlkampfveranstaltung in Kirchhain KOMPLETTE VERANSTALTUNG
AfD TV	819	122	Landtagswahl in Hessen 2018: Wahlkampfabschluss in Wiesbaden
AfD TV	750	114	Der große Wahlkampf-Abschluss der AfD!
AfD TV	574	103	Rede von Jörg Meuthen in Kirchhain
AfD TV	441	97	Jörg Meuthen in Lindheim
AfD TV	371	93	Jörg Meuthen beim Politischen Aschermittwoch in Bayern
AfD TV	311	87	Dr. Gottfried Curio: „Unser Land ist kein Siedlungsplatz – es ist unsere Heimat!“
AfD TV	468	84	“Wir sind die Partei der Autofahrer!“ Jörg Meuthen
AfD TV	423	80	7 Tage Deutschland – der AfD Wochenendpodcast 11/2021 mit diesen Themen:
AfD TV	310	78	Rede von Peter Boehringer beim Politischen Aschermittwoch 2021
AfD BT	2744	132	1. Agrarsymposium der AfD-Fraktion im Bundestag – Tag 2
AfD BT	2545	116	3. Corona-Symposium – Tag 1 – AfD-Fraktion im Bundestag
AfD BT	846	94	Vortragsabend mit Jörg Meuthen, Vaclav Klaus, David Engels, Harald Weyel und Norbert Kleinwächter
AfD BT	1266	91	2. Alternativer Frauenkongress - AfD-Fraktion im Bundestag
AfD BT	499	80	Global oder national? - Vortrag von Prof. Dr. Eberhard Hamer - mit Peter Boehringer & Udo Hemmelgarn
AfD BT	948	70	Alice Weidel, Dirk Spaniel & Marc Bernhard in Stuttgart-Vaihingen 21.07.

Channel	Sents	Anti-Elite	Title
AfD BT	786	70	Israel und die europäische Rechte – ein wechselreiches Verhältnis! - AfD-Fraktion im Bundestag
AfD BT	939	69	Genderneusprech: Nur der Teufel bleibt männlich! - AfD-Fraktion im Bundestag
AfD BT	553	67	Joachim Steinhöfel: Linksextreme und Meinungsfreiheit im Internet! - AfD-Fraktion im Bundestag
AfD BT	944	66	"Euro - Staatsstreich durch die Hintertür" mit Dr. Bruno Bandulet & Peter Boehringer - AfD-Fraktion

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Table C1: This table shows the top 10 most anti-elitist videos per channel. Anti-Elite shows the fraction of sentences that are classified as anti-elitist in each video.